

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

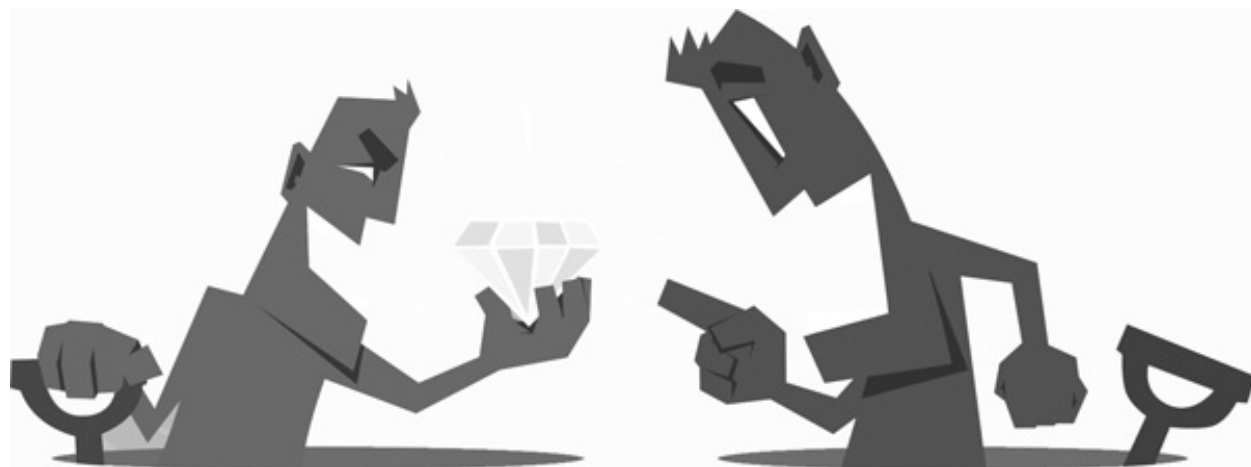
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Opals flash color in the light!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- What myths or legends do you know from Colombia?
- Do you think it is important to pass on myths and legends through generations? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about different cultures, myths and legends.
- I can talk about unusual events in the past.
- I can report facts about events or actions.





Let's Explore!

An Aboriginal **elder*** recounts a story.

* In Aboriginal culture, an "elder" is a wise person, but they are not necessarily an older person.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

The Aboriginal elder, Ngaka, of the Wangkumara Aboriginal group said that there was a Dreamtime legend being told that day. "The story of how opal stones gave us the gift of fire being recounted here is important", he said. Being reminded of our stories is part of Aboriginal life. Our legends being brought to life and being passed on help to keep us centered as a people.

Ngaka stands. He has just now begun to tell the story. "It's thousands of years ago," he says, "and the Wangkumara people have recently sent a pelican to explore another part of the country.

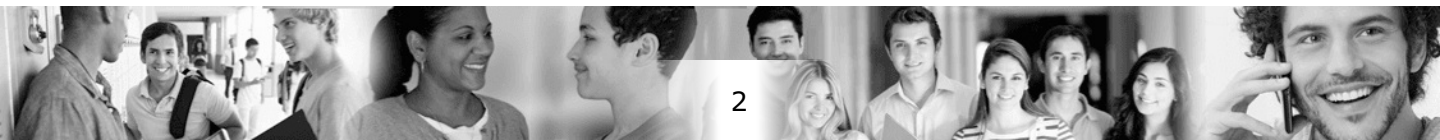
Pelican has just flown out across the land with fish in the pouch under his beak which is full of water to keep the fish fresh. He needs the fish because the Wangkumara people have asked him not to stop during his journey of discovery."

Ngaka continues. "Pelican feels sick and so, just now, he has decided to rest on top of a high hill. Have you ever needed to stop because your body is unhappy about not having rested? Well, this is just what has happened to Pelican. Then, while he's looking out over the land, he notices magnificent colors on the terrain below. What he is seeing is opal."

"Being curious," Ngaka says, smiling, "Pelican has now begun pecking at the colored stones with his beak. All of a sudden, a spark flies. Now a fire is being lit by the sparks in the dry grass nearby. The flames spread for miles, eventually reaching a group of Wangkumara Aborigines camping by the creek."

"Have the people ever seen fire before? No, they have not! Soon they realize they can cook their food with this fire. Soon, meat and fish being roasted in the fire is usual for Wangkumara families."

"We always need reminding," says Ngaka, "of this gift that has come into our possession."





Let's Practice!

What did the Aborigines say?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Classify the sentences into the correct category.

1. The group said that there was a Dreamtime legend.
2. He has decided to rest on top of a high hill.
3. Have the people ever seen fire before?
4. The opal stones gave us the gift of fire.
5. Pelican has just flown out across the land.
6. The flames spread for miles.

Actions connected to the present

--

Actions started and finished in the past

--



Let's Practice!

What do we know about the Wangkumara?

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the mistake. Rewrite the sentences correctly.

1. Be reminded of our stories is part of Aboriginal life.

2. Our legends being bring to life help keep us centered.

3. Meat and fish be roasted are typical for Wangkumara families.

4. Now a fire is be lit by the sparks.

5. The stories being pass on are part of the people's tradition.





Extension Activity

Talk about Australian Aboriginal Dreamtime paintings.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library to find pictures of Australian Aboriginal Dreamtime paintings.
- Look at them and take some notes.
- Consider the colors and images in the paintings.
- Look at the movement and subject matter.
- Read some background on the paintings or artists.
- Note any good new vocabulary words you can use to talk about the paintings.
- Share what you have found out with a partner or a group.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I find pictures of Australian Aboriginal Dreamtime paintings.

☐ ☐

I take some notes on the painting, considering color, movement, subject matter and images.

☐ ☐

I find out the meaning of new vocabulary.

☐ ☐

I describe the paintings to a partner or group.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- pelican** (noun): a large water bird that eats fish
e.g. The Wangkumara people have recently sent a pelican to explore another part of the country.
- pouch** (noun): a soft bag of skin
e.g. Pelican has just flown out across the land with fish in the pouch under his beak.
- discovery** (noun): something found for the first time
e.g. The people have asked him not to stop during his journey of discovery.
- opal** (noun): a semi-precious milky stone that flashes color
e.g. What he is seeing is opal.
- to peck** (verb): to bite with a beak
e.g. Pelican has now begun pecking at the colored stones with his beak.
- spark** (noun): a small bit of live fire
e.g. All of a sudden, a spark flies.
- eventually** (adverb): after a long time
e.g. The flames spread for miles, eventually reaching a group of Wangkumara Aborigines camping by a creek.





Learning Points

The Passive Gerund

You use the passive form of a gerund to emphasize that the subject of the sentence is being acted upon.

Look at the following example:

*Our legends **being brought** to life and **being passed on** help to keep us centered as a people.*

Here, the focus is on the legends, the receiver of the action. The agent, or 'doer', of the action (in this case, 'people') is not the focus. It is understood by the context of the writing that the 'doer' of the action (bring to life, pass on) are people and therefore not important.

Using passive forms of gerunds adds variety and depth to your writing. This style of writing is used often in stories, articles and academic texts.

Notice the structure of the passive gerund:

to be +-ing + past participle

Notice the passive gerund in the following sentences.

Examples:

- *The Aboriginal elder, Ngaka, of the Wangkumara Aboriginal group said that there was a Dreamtime legend being told that day.*
- *"The story of how opal stones gave us the gift of fire being recounted here is important", he said.*
- *Being reminded of our stories is part of Aboriginal life.*
- *Now a fire is being lit by the sparks in the dry grass nearby.*
- *Soon, meat and fish being roasted in the fire is usual for Wangkumara families.*





Learning Points

Present Perfect for Unusual Events

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about unusual events since you use this tense to connect past events with present situations.

You use the Present Perfect tense:

- For something that started in the past and continues in the present:

They've been married for almost thirty years.

He has lived in Toronto all his life.

- For something that has only recently happened:

*Pelican has **just** flown out across the land.*

*He has **just** now begun to tell the story.*

*The Wangkumara people have **recently** sent a pelican to explore another part of the country.*

You use the words *just*, *only just* and *recently* in these contexts.

- When we are talking about our experience up to the present:

*My last holiday was the worst holiday I **have ever had**.*

Have you ever seen a fire before?

No, ***I've never seen*** a fire.

You often use the adverb *ever* to talk about experience up to the present and you use *never* for the negative form

- for something that happened in the past but is important at the time of speaking:

I can't get in the house. I've lost my keys.

Take a look at the examples from the text:

Examples:

- *He has just now begun to tell the story.*
- *Wangkumara people have recently sent a pelican to explore another part of the country.*
- *Pelican has just flown out across the land with fish in the pouch under his beak.*
- *Have you ever needed to stop?*
- *Well this is just what has happened to Pelican.*
- *Pelican has now begun pecking at the colored stones with his beak.*
- *Have the people ever seen fire before?*

